GUARANATUBA REDD+ AUDD GROUPED PROJECT

Project title	*Guaranatuba REDD+ AUDD Grouped Project*
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Version	*V2*
VCS Standard Version	*4.5*
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CONTENTS

1 PROJECT DETAILS

1.1 Summary Description of the Project

The GUARANATUBA REDD+ AUDD Grouped Project (GPD) is a groundbreaking initiative that aims to combat unplanned deforestation and promote the conservation of Amazon rainforests within the states of Amazonia in Brazil. This project directly addresses the critical need for sustainable forest management and greenhouse gas (GHG) emission reductions in a region that spans approximately half of the state's territory, including areas near the notorious Deforestation Arc, known for its alarming rates of forest loss.

Situated in the heart of the Amazon, the project encompasses 101 properties across the municipalities of Urucara, Maues and Parintins, with total area of 3910 Ha, covering 2928 hectares of lush rainforest. By implementing a comprehensive strategy that includes legal protection for forests, advanced monitoring through satellite imagery, biodiversity and biomass inventorying using cutting-edge technology like LiDAR, as well as wildfire monitoring and prevention, and community engagement initiatives, the GUARANATUBA project is poised to generate significant climate benefits. Based on a 6-year jurisdictional baseline, the project is estimated to achieve an average annual reduction of 5.856 tCO_2e by preventing unplanned deforestation and promoting forest conservation.

Prior to the project's initiation, the targeted regions were highly vulnerable to rapid deforestation, primarily driven by agricultural expansion, illegal logging, and a lack of adequate conservation incentives. To address these challenges, the GUARANATUBA project, in partnership with Organica Consultoria LTDA, introduces a unique financial model that offers economic incentives to landowners for forest conservation. This innovative approach not only enables access to the carbon voluntary market but also supports the sustainable management of forested areas and ensures the legal enforcement of conservation efforts.

Beyond its environmental objectives, the GUARANATUBA project also seeks to foster positive impacts on local communities and biodiversity. By promoting a harmonious coexistence between economic development and environmental stewardship, the project aims to enhance the livelihoods of local communities while safeguarding the rich biodiversity of the Amazon rainforest.

In summary, the GUARANATUBA REDD+ AUDD Grouped Project sets a new standard for innovative conservation efforts in the states of Amazonia. Through the strategic combination of technological advancements, economic incentives, and community engagement, this project not only strives to reduce GHG emissions and prevent deforestation but also to protect biodiversity and improve the well-being of local communities. As such, the GUARANATUBA project represents a holistic model for tackling the urgent challenges of climate change and environmental degradation in one of the world's most vital ecosystems.

1.2 Audit History

Audit type	Period	Program	Validation/verification body name	Number of years
Validation/ verification	*(DD-Month-YYYY-- DD-Month-YYYY)*	*VCS*	*Validation/verification body name*	*One year*
	…			

To be developed

1.3 Sectoral Scope and Project Type

Complete the table below with information relevant for AFOLU projects:

Sectoral scope	AFOLU – 14
AFOLU project category[1]	REDD
Project activity type	AUDD

The GPD falls under the sectoral scope 14 of Agriculture, Forestry, and Other Land Use (AFOLU) and is a Reduced Emissions from Deforestation and Degradation (REDD) initiative, specifically classified as an Avoiding Unplanned Deforestation and/or Degradation (AUDD) project. This report is a preliminary draft of the grouped project documentation, initially comprising 40 activity instances related to the project.

1.4 Project Eligibility

1.4.1 General eligibility

The GUARANATUBA REDD+ AUDD Grouped Project is fully committed to meeting all general requirements set forth by the VCS Program, ensuring the integrity and consistency of its certification process. The project strictly adheres to the principles outlined in Section 2.2.1, guiding its design, implementation, and operation to maintain the highest standards of environmental and social responsibility.

In line with Section 3.1.2, the GUARANATUBA project applies methodologies that are eligible under the VCS Program, specifically the VM0015 Methodology for Avoided Unplanned Deforestation v1.2. The project applies this methodology in full, including all tools and modules referenced within, guaranteeing a comprehensive and rigorous approach to quantifying GHG emission reductions and removals.

To ensure the use of the most up-to-date and scientifically robust methodologies, the GUARANATUBA project complies with Section 3.1.3, applying the latest version of the applicable methodology unless a grace period applies. In the event of a baseline

[1] *See Appendix 1 of the* VCS Standard

reassessment or crediting period renewal, the project will update to the most recent version of the methodology, maintaining its alignment with the latest VCS Program requirements.

The GUARANATUBA project is committed to operating within the boundaries of all applicable laws, as stipulated in Section 3.1.4. The project's activities are designed and implemented in a manner that prevents any violation of legal requirements, regardless of the level of enforcement. This commitment to legal compliance ensures that the project contributes to sustainable development while respecting local, regional, and national regulations.

In instances where the applied methodology allows for the project proponent's choice of model, as per Section 3.1.5, the GUARANATUBA project selects models that meet the VCS Methodology Requirements. The appropriateness of the chosen models to the project's specific circumstances is demonstrated during the validation process, ensuring accurate quantification of GHG emission reductions and removals.

Similarly, when the applied methodology permits the use of third-party default factors or standards for ascertaining GHG emission data and supporting information for establishing baseline scenarios and demonstrating additionality, as outlined in Section 3.1.6, the GUARANATUBA project selects factors and standards that comply with the VCS Methodology Requirements. This approach guarantees the credibility and reliability of the data used in the project's calculations and assessments.

In the event of any conflict between the rules and requirements of an approved GHG program and those of the VCS Program, the GUARANATUBA project prioritizes the VCS Program's rules and requirements, as stated in Section 3.1.7. This hierarchy ensures that the project maintains consistency with the overarching VCS Program framework.

When applying methodologies from approved GHG programs, the GUARANATUBA project conforms to any specified capacity limits and other relevant requirements set out in the application of the methodology and/or tools referenced by the methodology under those programs, as per Section 3.1.8. This compliance guarantees the project's alignment with the specific guidelines and constraints of the applied methodologies.

Lastly, the GUARANATUBA project remains proactive in adapting to new VCS Program rules as they are issued. By closely following the effective dates specified in Appendix 3 Document History and Effective Dates or equivalent for other program documents, and referring to the companion Summary of Effective Dates document, as described in Section 3.1.9, the project ensures its ongoing compliance with the most current VCS Program requirements.

By strictly adhering to these general requirements, the GUARANATUBA REDD+ AUDD Grouped Project demonstrates its unwavering commitment to maintaining the highest standards of environmental integrity, transparency, and accountability, while actively contributing to the global effort to mitigate climate change through the reduction of GHG emissions and the enhancement of carbon dioxide removals.

1.4.2 AFOLU project eligibility

The GUARANATUBA REDD+ AUDD Grouped Project is designed to meet the specific requirements and standards set forth by the VCS Program version 4.5 for Agriculture, Forestry, and Other Land Use (AFOLU) projects. This section demonstrates how the project's design and operational protocols align with the AFOLU project eligibility criteria and operational standards outlined in the VCS Program.

AFOLU Project Categories and Eligibility (VCS Standard v4.5, Section 3.2.1):

The GUARANATUBA project falls under the Reduced Emissions from Deforestation and Degradation (REDD) project category, as defined in Appendix 1 of the VCS Program. Specifically, the project focuses on Avoiding Unplanned Deforestation and Degradation (AUDD) within the Amazonas region. All project activities are designed to be consistent with the VCS Methodology Requirements and fall within the scope of the approved VM0015 methodology for REDD projects.

Compliance with Jurisdictional REDD+ Programs (VCS Standard v4.5, Section 3.2.2):

The project area is located within a jurisdiction that may be covered by a jurisdictional REDD+ program. As such, the GUARANATUBA project adheres to both the general requirements set forth in the VCS Program and the nested project requirements detailed in the Jurisdictional and Nested REDD+ Requirements. This ensures that the project is harmonized with broader efforts to mitigate deforestation and degradation within the jurisdiction.

Implementation Partnership (VCS Standard v4.5, Section 3.2.3):

Organica Consultoria LTDA has been identified as the implementation partner for the GUARANATUBA project. The project description clearly outlines the roles and responsibilities of Organica Consultoria LTDA in the implementation, management, and monitoring of the project throughout its crediting period. This partnership ensures that all project activities are executed effectively and in alignment with VCS standards.

Demonstration of GHG Benefit Implementation (VCS Standard v4.5, Section 3.2.4):

The GUARANATUBA project is committed to demonstrating that activities leading to the intended GHG benefits are implemented in accordance with the project design during each verification period. This includes ongoing activities such as forest patrols and the promotion of improved agricultural practices among community members. These efforts ensure the continued effectiveness of the project's conservation measures.

Baseline Reassessment Schedule (VCS Standard v4.5, Sections 3.2.5 and 3.2.6):

In line with the requirements for AUDD projects, the GUARANATUBA project will reassess its baseline every six years. This regular reassessment will take into account changes in land use, deforestation drivers, carbon stocks, and other relevant factors. The project will apply the latest VCS Program rules and the VM0015 methodology or its replacement at the time of baseline reassessment. The validity of the original baseline scenario will be reevaluated, and the project description will be updated to reflect any changes in the baseline scenario and emissions quantifications.

Adherence to Wetland and Other Specific Requirements (VCS Standard v4.5, Section 3.2.8):

Although the primary focus of the GUARANATUBA project is on REDD activities, it will ensure compliance with any applicable additional requirements related to wetland conservation and the maintenance of carbon stocks in the event of potential harvesting activities.

Non-Permanence Risk Management (VCS Standard v4.5, Sections 3.2.10 to 3.2.27):

The GUARANATUBA project will prepare a non-permanence risk report using the AFOLU Non-Permanence Risk Assessment Calculator at validation and verification, as required by Section 3.2.10. The project has committed to a minimum project longevity of 40 years, as stipulated in Section 3.2.11, demonstrating its dedication to long-term environmental sustainability and carbon stock security. The project will follow all applicable rules and procedures related to buffer credits, as outlined in the VCS Program Registration and Issuance Process.

By adhering to these AFOLU-specific requirements and operational standards, as detailed in the VCS Standard v4.5, the GUARANATUBA REDD+ AUDD Grouped Project demonstrates its eligibility and commitment to contributing to global efforts to reduce GHG emissions, while promoting sustainable land management practices within the crucial ecosystem of the Amazonas region.

1.5 Project Design

☒ Grouped project

1.5.1 Grouped project design

The GUARANATUBA REDD+ AUDD Grouped Project, aimed at Avoiding Unplanned Deforestation and Degradation (AUDD) within the states of Amazonia in Brazil, is designed as a grouped project in accordance with the Verified Carbon Standard (VCS) guidelines. Utilizing the VM0015 methodology, the project seeks to significantly reduce greenhouse gas (GHG) emissions by preventing unplanned deforestation across a wide geographic area. The following description outlines how the project meets the specific requirements for grouped projects under the VCS framework:

Geographic Delineation (VCS Standard v4.5, Section 3.6.10):

The GUARANATUBA Project has clearly defined the geographic area within which all project activity instances shall occur. This area encompasses the entire states of Brazilian Amazonia, specified using geodetic polygons as required by Section 3.11 of the VCS

Standard. The precise identification and demarcation of the project boundaries facilitate targeted conservation efforts within this highly biodiverse region.

Baseline Scenario and Additionality (VCS Standard v4.5, Sections 3.6.11 to 3.6.15):

In accordance with the VM0015 methodology, the project has established a comprehensive baseline that quantifies the expected emissions in the absence of the project's interventions. The baseline is determined for each designated geographic area, derived from historical deforestation rates, satellite imagery analysis, and ground truthing within the Amazonia states. Where a single baseline scenario cannot be determined for a project activity over the entirety of a geographic area, the area has been redefined or divided to ensure a single baseline scenario can be determined for the revised geographic area(s).

The additionality of the initial project activity instances has been demonstrated for each designated geographic area, in line with the VM0015 methodology. Factors such as existing threats of deforestation, financial barriers, and the lack of incentive for conservation without the project underline the additionality of the GUARANATUBA Project. Where the additionality of the initial project activity instances within a particular geographic area cannot be demonstrated for the entirety of that area, the geographic area has been redefined or divided to ensure the additionality of the instances occurring in the revised geographic area(s) can be demonstrated.

New Project Activity Instance Eligibility Criteria (VCS Standard v4.5, Section 3.6.16):

The GUARANATUBA Project has established clear eligibility criteria for the inclusion of new project activity instances at subsequent verification events. These criteria ensure that new instances meet the applicability conditions of the VM0015 methodology, use the specified technologies or measures in the same manner as described in the project description, are subject to the determined baseline scenario, and have additionality characteristics consistent with the initial instances for the specified project activity and geographic area.

Inclusion of New Project Activity Instances (VCS Standard v4.5, Sections 3.6.17 to 3.6.18):

New project activity instances shall occur within the designated geographic areas specified in the project description and conform with at least one complete set of eligibility criteria. They will be included in the monitoring report with sufficient information to demonstrate conformance with the applicable eligibility criteria and enable evidence gathering by the validation/verification body. The project proponent shall hold evidence of project ownership for each new instance from its respective start date, which shall be the same as or later than the grouped project start date. New instances are only eligible for crediting from the later of their start date or the start of the verification period in which they were added, through to the end of the total project crediting period. They must not be enrolled in another VCS project and shall adhere to the clustering and capacity limit requirements set out in Sections 3.6.8 and 3.6.9 of the VCS Standard.

Central GHG Information System and Monitoring Controls (VCS Standard v4.5, Section 3.6.22):

The GUARANATUBA Project employs a centralized GHG information system to accurately track, monitor, and report all emissions reductions and carbon sequestration activities. This system includes detailed records of baseline data, monitoring methodologies, and verification reports. The project description outlines the controls associated with the project and its monitoring to ensure data integrity, transparency, and compliance with the VM0015 methodology and VCS standards.

By structuring the project design to meet these requirements, the GUARANATUBA Project demonstrates its commitment to the rigorous standards for grouped projects under the VCS framework. The careful delineation of geographic areas, establishment of credible baselines and additionality, clear eligibility criteria for new project activity instances, and robust GHG information system and monitoring controls provide a solid foundation for the project's contribution to climate change mitigation efforts in the Brazilian Amazonia states.

1.6 Project Proponent

Provide contact information for the project proponent(s). Copy and paste the table as needed.

Organization name	ORGANICA CONSULTORIA LTDA
Contact person	Rémi Denecheau
Title	CEO
Address	Rua Barbosa de Freitas 1741, FORTALEZA-CE, BRAZIL
Telephone	+55 85 99106-3502
Email	*r.denecheau@organica-consulting.com*

1.7 Other Entities Involved in the Project

1.8 Ownership

The GUARANATUBA REDD+ AUDD Grouped Project demonstrates project ownership in conformance with the VCS Program requirements outlined in Section 3.7.1 of the VCS Standard v4.5. The project proponents have the legal right to control and operate project activities, as evidenced by the following:

1. Project ownership arising by virtue of a statutory, property, or contractual right in the land, vegetation, or conservational or management process that generates GHG emission reductions and/or removals (VCS Standard v4.5, Section 3.7.1(4)):

Each producer participating in the GUARANATUBA project holds a CAR (Environmental Rural Registry), which establishes their legal right to the land and the conservation processes that generate GHG emission reductions and removals. The CAR is a mandatory electronic registry for all rural properties in Brazil, created by Federal Law 12.651/2012, and serves as an official document demonstrating the landowner's rights and responsibilities concerning environmental conservation.

2. Project ownership arising under law (VCS Standard v4.5, Section 3.7.1(2)):

The project proponents' property documentation, such as land titles or deeds, further demonstrates their legal ownership of the land where project activities take place. These documents are legally recognized under Brazilian law and support the project proponents' claims to project ownership.

3. Project ownership arising from the implementation or enforcement of laws, statutes, or regulatory frameworks that require activities to be undertaken or incentivize activities that generate GHG emission reductions or carbon dioxide removals (VCS Standard v4.5, Section 3.7.1(7)):

The GUARANATUBA project's activities are aligned with and supported by various Brazilian laws and regulations that promote conservation and sustainable land use practices. For example, the Brazilian Forest Code (Law 12.651/2012) requires landowners to maintain a certain percentage of their property as a "Legal Reserve" (Reserva Legal) and preserve sensitive areas such as riparian zones and steep slopes. By complying with these legal requirements and engaging in additional conservation activities, the project proponents demonstrate project ownership arising from the implementation and enforcement of relevant legal frameworks.

4. Project ownership evidenced by the payment of CCIR (Rural Property Tax) (VCS Standard v4.5, Section 3.7.1(4)):

The project proponents' payment of the CCIR (Imposto sobre a Propriedade Territorial Rural) further reinforces their legal right to the land and the associated GHG emission reductions and removals. The CCIR is a federal tax levied on rural properties in Brazil, and its payment is evidence of the landowner's rightful possession and use of the land.

By providing this comprehensive evidence of project ownership, including statutory, property, and contractual rights in the land and the processes generating GHG emission reductions and removals, the GUARANATUBA project fully aligns with the VCS Standard's criteria for demonstrating legal rights over the project's operation and the resulting climate benefits.

1.9 Project Start Date

Project start date	*01/05/2021*
Justification	*as described below*

The GUARANATUBA REDD+ AUDD Grouped Project, an Agriculture, Forestry, and Other Land Use (AFOLU) initiative aimed at reducing emissions from deforestation and degradation within the Amazonia states of Brazil, has a start date of May 1st, 2021. This date aligns with the Verified Carbon Standard (VCS) Program's requirements for AFOLU project start dates and validation timelines, as outlined in Sections 3.8.2, 3.8.3, and 3.8.4 of the VCS Standard v4.5.

Definition of AFOLU Project Start Date (VCS Standard v4.5, Section 3.8):

According to the VCS Program guidelines, an AFOLU project's start date is defined as the date on which activities that lead to the generation of emission reductions or removals are implemented. For the GUARANATUBA Project, these activities include the implementation of comprehensive strategies to prevent unplanned deforestation and degradation, such as deploying conservation efforts, mobilizing communities, establishing monitoring and enforcement protocols, and initiating sustainable land management practices.

Prior to the official start date, the project proponents conducted extensive monitoring and implementation actions, including visits to the communities involved in the project. These preparatory activities laid the groundwork for the successful commencement of the project and ensured that all stakeholders were well-informed and engaged in the process.

The pivotal moment that marks the project's official start date is the signing of contracts with the landowners on May 1st, 2021. This event, which took place during a gathering with cooperatives of guarana producers, formalized the participation of the landowners in the GUARANATUBA Project and solidified their commitment to the project's objectives. The signing of these contracts signifies the beginning of the project's implementation phase, as it enables the project proponents to carry out the planned activities on the participating properties.

Compliance with Validation Timeframes for AFOLU Projects:

1. Pipeline Listing (VCS Standard v4.5, Section 3.8.2):

As per VCS requirement 3.8.2, AFOLU projects must initiate the pipeline listing process within three years of the project start date. In adherence to this guideline, the GUARANATUBA Project is set to be submitted for pipeline listing before May 1st, 2024, ensuring alignment with the VCS Program's registration and issuance protocol and demonstrating commitment to the prescribed timelines.

2. Completion of Validation (VCS Standard v4.5, Sections 3.8.3 and 3.8.4):

The GUARANATUBA Project, which falls under the REDD+ activities category and aims to prevent unplanned deforestation, is subject to the validation timeframe specified in Section 3.8.4 of the VCS Standard. As an AFOLU project with ex-ante emission reduction estimates exceeding 20,000 tCO_2e per year, the GUARANATUBA Project must complete validation within five years of its start date. Consequently, the project is strategically planned to conclude the validation process by April 30th, 2026, ensuring compliance with the VCS Program requirements and appropriate validation of the project type and scale within the stipulated timeframe.

By establishing a start date of May 1st, 2021, which coincides with the signing of contracts with landowners during a meeting with guarana producer cooperatives, and building upon the foundation of pre-implementation monitoring and community engagement activities, the GUARANATUBA Project demonstrates a strong commitment to the VCS Program's requirements for AFOLU projects. The project's adherence to the pipeline listing and validation deadlines, as well as its thorough preparation and stakeholder involvement, exemplify its dedication to meeting VCS standards and contributing effectively to global efforts in mitigating climate change through responsible environmental stewardship and sustainable forestry management practices in the Amazonas state.

1.10 Project Crediting Period

Crediting period	☐ *Seven years, twice renewable* ☐ *Ten years, fixed* ☒ *Other (30 years)*
Start and end date of first or fixed crediting period	*01-05-2021* to *30-04-2051*

1.11 Project Scale and Estimated GHG Emission Reductions or Removals

Indicate the estimated annual GHG emission reductions/removals (ERRs) of the project:

☒ < 300,000 tCO2e/year (project)

☐ ≥ 300,000 tCO2e/year (large project)

Complete the table below for the first (if renewable) or fixed crediting period:

Calendar year of crediting period	Estimated GHG emission reductions or removals (tCO_2e)
01-May-2021 to 31-December2021	3 904
01-January-2022 to 31-December-2050	169 824
01-January-2051 to 30-april-2051	1 952
...	
Total estimated ERRs during the first or fixed crediting period	175 680
Total number of years	30
Average annual ERRs	5856

1.12 Description of the Project Activity

The GUARANATUBA REDD+ AUDD Grouped Project encompasses a wide range of activities designed to generate climate, community, and biodiversity benefits. These activities are carefully planned and implemented to ensure the project's success in achieving its objectives and contributing to sustainable development in the Brazilian Amazonia states.

One of the key activities is training and partnerships to strengthen social organization. This involves providing training on social organization and associativism, as well as encouraging and supporting the creation and development of associations to organize work and represent the communities. This activity is of very high relevance to the project's objectives, as organization in associations is essential for generating income and strengthening the identity of community groups. In the short term, this activity will lead to increased knowledge and skills in social organization and associativism, as well as the establishment or strengthening of community associations. In the medium term, it will contribute to improved income generation and community representation, ultimately supporting livelihoods and employment (SDG 1, 8).

Another important activity is the formation of fire brigades and the provision of appropriate materials. This involves periodic training and exercises, as well as the delivery of firefighting equipment. The goal is to foster good fire management and firefighting practices among communities to prevent the spread of wildfires in the project area. This activity is of very high relevance, as fire is traditionally used in the Amazon as an instrument for suppressing regenerating vegetation or clearing lands of forests for pastures and agriculture. The creation of fire brigades would make a fundamental contribution to wildfire impact mitigation. In the short term, this activity will result in trained community members in fire management and firefighting, as well as the provision of necessary equipment. In the medium term, it will lead to a reduced incidence and spread of wildfires in the project area, contributing to wildfire GHG emission reduction (SDG 13).

The project also places a strong emphasis on education and awareness-raising. Carbon pedagogy lectures will be conducted, covering topics such as environment, forests, environmental services, biodiversity, environmental conservation, climate change, carbon cycle, environmental legislation, and labor legislation. These lectures are highly relevant to the project's objectives, as involving and engaging children and young people through educational processes is essential to ensure the effectiveness of the project. It helps them understand the project's themes and defend its importance for forest conservation and the communities' livelihoods. In the short term, this activity will lead to increased environmental awareness and knowledge among children and youth, as well as an enhanced understanding of the project's objectives and importance. In the medium term, it will contribute to an improved quality of environmental education and an increased sense of ownership and belonging among young community members (SDG 4).

The volunteer environmental monitor program is another crucial component of the project. This involves training community members on pressures and threats to territories and engaging them in monitoring activities to reduce these pressures and threats. This program is highly relevant to the project's objectives, as it contributes to the reduction of deforestation by empowering community members to become monitors of threats and pressures in the territories. In the short term, this activity will result in trained community members in identifying and reporting threats to the forest, as well as increased monitoring of the project area. In the medium term, it will lead to reduced pressures and threats to the forest, contributing to wildfire GHG emission reduction (SDG 13).

The project also recognizes the importance of health and well-being. Sensitization and awareness campaigns will be conducted for the prevention of tropical and other diseases, as well as sexual and reproductive health. These campaigns are of very high relevance, as many common diseases in the region occur due to a lack of awareness and knowledge about forms of prevention. In the short term, these campaigns will lead to increased knowledge about disease prevention and sexual and reproductive health. In the medium term, they will contribute to a reduced incidence of tropical and other diseases and improved women's health (SDG 3, 4).

Gender equality and women's empowerment are also key focus areas of the project. The project encourages the creation of women's groups for dialogues on topics related to female empowerment, such as women's rights, domestic violence, social division of labor, and women's entrepreneurship. This activity is highly relevant, as many spaces in society are predominantly occupied by men, and this becomes even more common in communities, depending on their culture. Encouraging women's self-organized spaces is essential to increasing women's participation in project actions, such as their financial autonomy and empowerment. In the short term, this activity will lead to the establishment of women's dialogue groups and increased awareness of women's rights and empowerment. In the medium term, it will contribute to enhanced women's participation in project activities and improved well-being and empowerment of women (SDG 4, 5, 8).

Biodiversity conservation is another critical aspect of the project. The project conducts fauna monitoring, focusing on mammals, birds, reptiles, and amphibians, and prepares monitoring reports on endemic and game species. This activity is of very high relevance, as the project area is located in a High Conservation Value (HCV) area, with the occurrence of rare, threatened, and endemic species, and is connected to a landscape with ecosystem functions of global relevance. In the short term, this activity will result in completed fauna monitoring campaigns and monitoring reports on endemic and game species. In the medium term, it will contribute to the maintenance of species monitoring campaigns and the promotion of species conservation through the maintenance of forest habitats and the avoidance of hunting pressure (SDG 15).

Forest surveillance is a fundamental component of the project, focusing on monitoring deforestation, forest degradation, and burn scars. The project aims to annually monitor 6,000 hectares of forests, which is of very high relevance, considering that the average GHG emission caused by land-use change in Brazil is approximately 1 Gt CO2e, representing half of the national emission profile. Deforestation in the Amazon biome in Brazil surpassed 11,000 km2 in 2021 and shows an increasing trend. In the short term, this activity will result in the annual monitoring of 3,910 hectares of lands. In the medium term, it will contribute to the maintenance of 2,928 hectares of forest cover and the reduction of GHG emissions due to deforestation displacement (SDG 13).

Finally, the project places a strong emphasis on leakage management. This involves the implementation of leakage mitigation measures to ensure the project's net positive impact on GHG emissions and to maintain the integrity of the project's climate benefits. This activity is highly relevant, as effectively managing leakage is crucial to the project's success. In the short term, this activity will lead to the identification of potential leakage risks and the development and implementation of leakage mitigation strategies. In the medium term, it will contribute to reduced leakage of deforestation and associated emissions to areas outside the project boundary (SDG 13).

These activities, collectively, aim to generate significant climate benefits through reduced deforestation and associated GHG emissions, while also promoting sustainable livelihoods, enhancing biodiversity conservation, and fostering social empowerment within the communities living in the project area. The project's holistic approach, addressing multiple dimensions of sustainability, aligns with several Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) and contributes to the long-term well-being of both the environment and the people in the Amazonas state.

1.13 Project Location

The Guaranatuba REDD+ AUDD grouped project comprises an initial total of 101 project activity instances distributed across the municipalities of Urucara, Maues, Parintins, as can be seen on maps below.

The table below lists the properties included in this grouped project and a geographical coordinate centroid for each PAI (See Table). Coordinates are also submitted separately as a KML file of the properties boundaries (ANNEX).

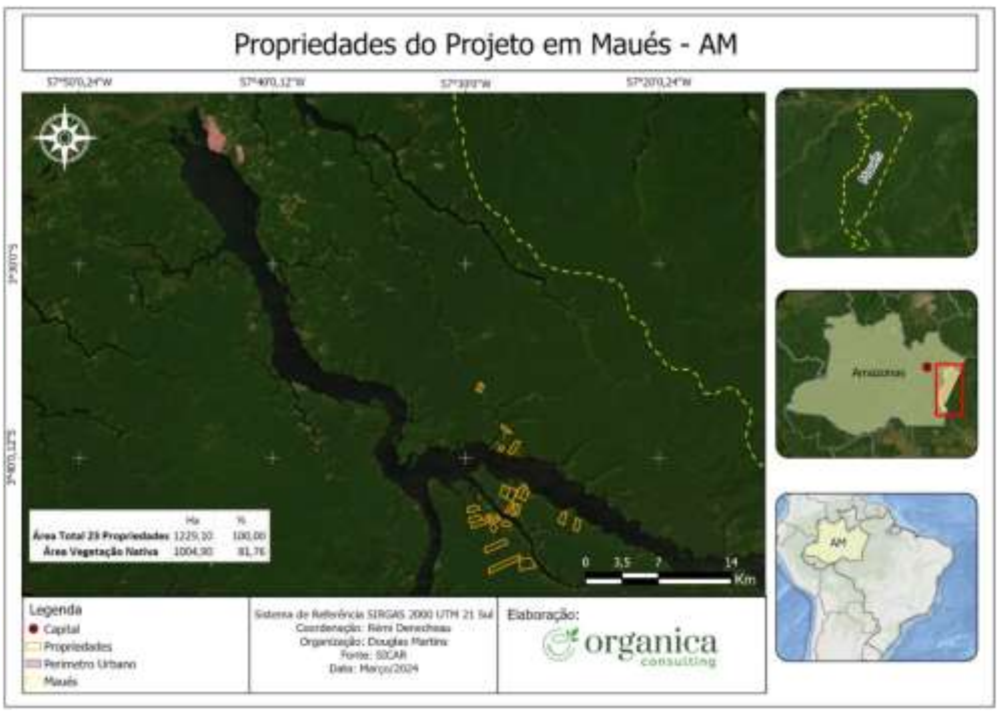
Table - Project Instance centroid coordinates and municipality.

PAI	Property Owner Name	Municipality	X (Long)	Y (Lat)
1	JOSE NILDO DE ALMEIDA	MAUES/AM	-57,47	-3,64
2	MARIA LEONICE FERREIRA	MAUES/AM	-57,49	-3,72
3	RAIMUNDO DOS SANTOS	MAUES/AM	-57,48	-3,72
4	NATANAEL DOS SANTOS MENEZES	MAUES/AM	-57,45	-3,70
5	MARA DOS SANTOS E OZIEL DOS SANTOS	MAUES/AM	-57,45	-3,70
6	VAGNER MATOS DA SILVA	MAUES/AM	-57,48	-3,61
7	VALDIRLENE FERREIRA E VALDIVINO DOS SANTOS	MAUES/AM	-57,49	-3,72
8	FRANCISCO CAVALCANTE E SONIANA SARRAFE	MAUES/AM	-57,46	-3,70
9	JORGE MENEZES	MAUES/AM	-57,46	-3,71
10	JOSE FRANCISCO AMAZONAS/ ROSA DOS SANTOS	MAUES/AM	-57,47	-3,76
11	JANDERSON FERREIRA PAZ	MAUES/AM	-57,46	-3,72
12	ERIC MAROTTA BROSLER	MAUES/AM	-57,47	-3,74
13	EZIOMAR GUIMARAES DE LIMA	MAUES/AM	-57,40	-3,72
14	FABILSON CORREA DA SILVA	MAUES/AM	-57,49	-3,61
15	ELIEZIO DE SOUZA E FRANCISCA AMAZONAS	MAUES/AM	-57,48	-3,72

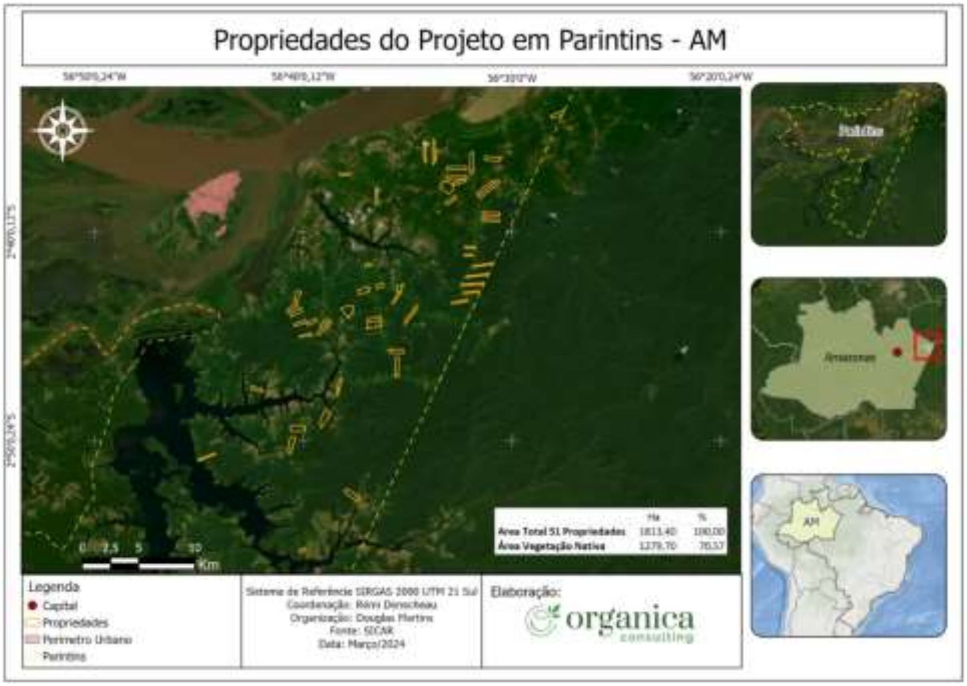
16	ERALDO MENEZES E MARIA DE LOUDES	MAUES/AM	-57,45	-3,76
17	ALICIO LOBO MICHILES	MAUES/AM	-57,47	-3,72
18	AURELIO FILHO E MARIA JOSE DA SILVA	MAUES/AM	-57,46	-3,71
19	CLEANE DE SOUZA E JANDERSON PAZ	MAUES/AM	-57,45	-3,70
20	ADEMIR DE OLIVEIRA E ANTONIO DE OLIVEIRA	MAUES/AM	-57,47	-3,70
21	ALDO PAIVA E JULIO CESAR DO CARMO	MAUES/AM	-57,42	-3,72
22	ADEILSON DE SOUZA E AMELIA CAVALCANTE	MAUES/AM	-57,47	-3,72
23	ADEILSON DE SOUZA E AMELIA CAVALCANTE	MAUES/AM	-57,48	-3,73
24	ALCIANE DE OLIVEIRA	PARINTINS/AM	-56,53	-2,70
25	ADRELINA CERDEIRA	PARINTINS/AM	-56,74	-2,85
26	ANTONIA DE ANDRADE OLIVEIRA	PARINTINS/AM	-56,53	-2,68
27	CANDIDA MARIA DOS SANTOS	PARINTINS/AM	-56,59	-2,72
28	CIDIANE PINTO DE CASTRO	PARINTINS/AM	-56,56	-2,60
29	DIELE DE OLIVEIRA ALBUQUERQUE	PARINTINS/AM	-56,46	-2,57
30	ELISANGELA DE SOUSA E AZIEL DE SOUSA	PARINTINS/AM	-56,66	-2,92
31	ERCELINO XAVIER VALENTE	PARINTINS/AM	-56,53	-2,71
32	ERANEIDE BATISTA DA SILVA	PARINTINS/AM	-56,54	-2,72
33	FELIPE CURSINO MARTINS	PARINTINS/AM	-56,53	-2,68
34	FRANCISCO PAULO BARBOSA	PARINTINS/AM	-56,66	-2,75
35	IARA TAVARES CARDOSO	PARINTINS/AM	-56,64	-2,74
36	MARIA IRAIDES DA SILVA E RAIMUNDO TEXEIRA	PARINTINS/AM	-56,66	-2,73
37	IRINEIA OLIVEIRA DE SOUSA	PARINTINS/AM	-56,61	-2,64
38	JOSE ALBERTO BARBOSA	PARINTINS/AM	-56,67	-2,72
39	LUIZ MEIO DA SILVA	PARINTINS/AM	-56,58	-2,73
40	MAILZO OLIVEIRA MOURAO	PARINTINS/AM	-56,67	-2,72
41	MARIA BELITA XAVIER	PARINTINS/AM	-56,61	-2,69
42	MARIA DAS DORES LIMA	PARINTINS/AM	-56,63809	-2,78917
43	MARIA NEIDE VIEIRA	PARINTINS/AM	-56,54227332	-2,627006327
44	MARIA REGINA PEREIRA	PARINTINS/AM	-56,63346677	-2,620700418
45	MARILZA NATIVIDADE SIMOES	PARINTINS/AM	-56,52343664	-2,693104318
46	NELITA PRATA DA SILVA	PARINTINS/AM	-56,56120618	-2,605584076
47	OSVALDO DE SOUSA LEAL	PARINTINS/AM	-56,672108	-2,730645
48	RAIMUNDO XAVIER RIBEIRO	PARINTINS/AM	-56,605554	-2,709590
49	RUTH DOS SANTOS CARNEIRO	PARINTINS/AM	-56,527953	-2,701431
50	SAFIRA MOREIRA FERREIRA	PARINTINS/AM	-56,70384792	-2,79206091
51	SOCORRO FERREIRA DA SILVA	PARINTINS/AM	-56,54904420	-2,64155028
52	VICENTE PAULO DE CASTRO	PARINTINS/AM	-56,57	-2,60
53	MARIA GERCI TAVARES	PARINTINS/AM	-56,5896987	-2,7114524
54	IZA BRELAZ	PARINTINS/AM	-56,55	-2,63

55	ABIGAIL MEDEIROS E FIRMINO DOS SANTOS	PARINTINS/AM	-56,65	-2,73
56	JOÃO BATISTA NUNES	PARINTINS/AM	-56,63085884	-2,729463243
57	ENESTINO MONTEIRO	PARINTINS/AM	-56,62	-2,87
58	ALMIR MELO	PARINTINS/AM	-56,67	-2,82
59	MARCILDA DA SILVA	PARINTINS/AM	-56,64973186	-2,815117539
60	RAIMUNDA GEMAQUE	PARINTINS/AM	-56,51846133	-2,632561105
61	ERNANDES BARROSO	PARINTINS/AM	-56,53	-2,61
62	CARMEM MARIA DOS SANTOS	PARINTINS/AM	-56,61	-2,74
63	JOÃO VICSOR MARTINS	PARINTINS/AM	-56,54	-2,61
64	DANILDA DOS SANTOS	PARINTINS/AM	-56,52	-2,63
65	LUIZ DOS SANTOS/EDILENE DOS SANTOS	PARINTINS/AM	-56,67648512	-2,836205979
66	ALBERTO DE SOUZA	PARINTINS/AM	-56,59	-2,77
67	MARIA DO CARMO RAMOS	PARINTINS/AM	-56,54427733	-2,623300124
68	MARIA DOS SANTOS DA SILVA	PARINTINS/AM	-56,65036597	-2,743675465
69	NEUSA MARIA BARROSO	PARINTINS/AM	-56,51559186	-2,608213738
70	JOSÉ DE LIMA/LUCIMAR DE LIMA	PARINTINS/AM	-56,61	-2,73
71	SANCHA DA SILVA	PARINTINS/AM	-56,5921602	-2,761906863
72	IRINEIA MARIA AMARAL	PARINTINS/AM	-56,61	-2,71
73	MARIA DE LOURDES GRAÇA	PARINTINS/AM	-56,51700667	-2,657064826
74	JUCILEUZA PINTO RIBEIRO	PARINTINS/AM	-56,51658902	-2,652173198
75	ALBINO DE SOUZA PIRES	URUCARÁ/AM	-57,65651185	-2,429658443
76	ADAMOR MACEDO PINTO	URUCARÁ/AM	-57,71724751	-2,484735746
77	ANTONIO FONSECA DOS SANTOS	URUCARÁ/AM	-57,76335139	-2,481140705
78	ANTONIO CARLOS MONTEIRO FONSECA	URUCARÁ/AM	-57,73671881	-2,46122242
79	ANDREIA NOGUEIRA PAES	URUCARÁ/AM	-57,6839501	-2,387466699
80	EDER MOISES PAES FONSECA	URUCARÁ/AM	-57,682784	-2,442742355
81	JOÃO SOARES VIEIRA FILHO	URUCARÁ/AM	-57,72204171	-2,515708562
82	ANTONIO SOUZA DE ANDRADE	URUCARÁ/AM	-57,73201979	-2,486179636
83	JOSÉ MARCIO QUEIROZ	URUCARÁ/AM	-57,66845907	-2,426077932
84	LOURIVAL DOS SANTOS PAES	URUCARÁ/AM	-57,68938915	-2,444845048
85	JOSÉ ESTEVES PAES	URUCARÁ/AM	-57,706383	-2,425629861
86	MANOEL DE JESUS FERREIRA	URUCARÁ/AM	-57,86916497	-2,51251238
87	MANOEL DE SOUZA PAES	URUCARÁ/AM	-57,64966017	-2,438491602
88	MANOEL MONTEIRO DA SILVA	URUCARÁ/AM	-57,6569829	-2,427225093
89	MANOEL ADEMIR BRAGA	URUCARÁ/AM	-57,67457177	-2,455496276
90	RUI MARQUES FILHO	URUCARÁ/AM	-57,75853323	-2,478852048
91	TEÓFILO ESPIRITO SANTO	URUCARÁ/AM	-57,66603238	-2,446149676
92	VITORINO DA SILVA SANTOS	URUCARÁ/AM	-57,68854458	-2,407552981
93	MANOEL RAIMUNDO DE MELO	URUCARÁ/AM	-57,68866214	-2,433502929

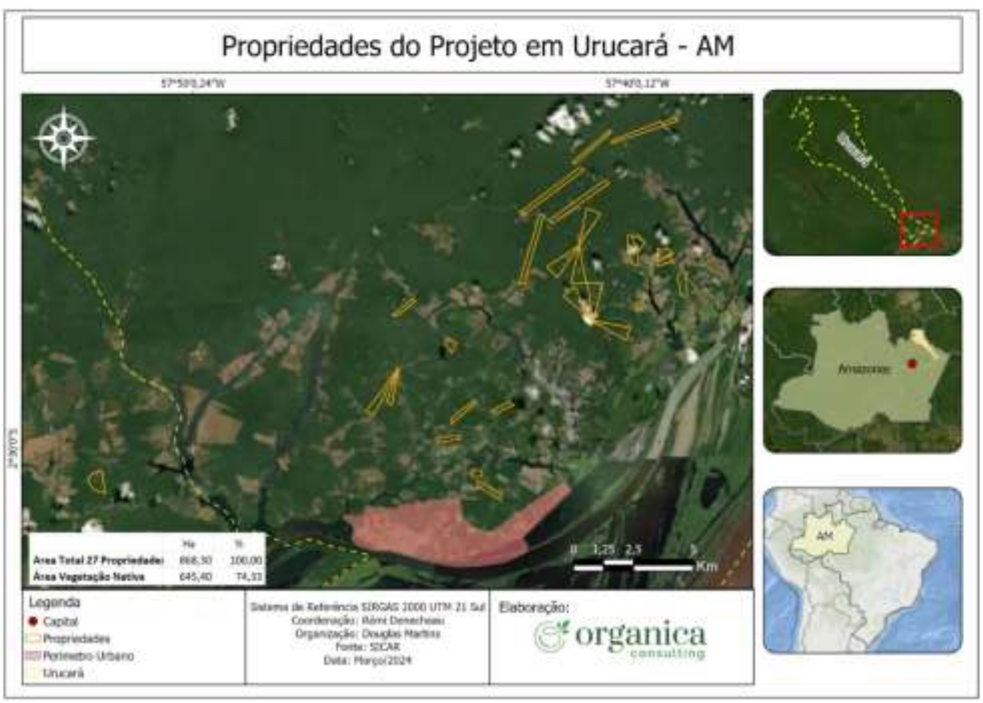
94	MANOEL PEDRO BRAGA PAES	URUCARÁ/AM	-57,72693202	-2,509395858
95	MARIA BERNADETE DA SILVA	URUCARÁ/AM	-57,69527237	-2,430701924
96	MATEUS GARCIA PAES	URUCARÁ/AM	-57,69841475	-2,4033835
97	MARCELO MONTEIRO DA SILVA	URUCARÁ/AM	-57,6569829	-2,427225093
98	RAIMUNDO DO ESPIRITO SANTO	URUCARÁ/AM	-57,66345193	-2,380606671
99	RAIMUNDO HILÁRIO PONTES	URUCARÁ/AM	-57,68487326	-2,415373902
100	RONISON DE SOUZA LAVAREDA	URUCARÁ/AM	-57,75393768	-2,447230039
101	ODIÉLIO NASCIMENTO DOS SANTOS	URUCARÁ/AM	-57,73784481	-2,496415828



Map of 23 properties in Maues (total area : 1229 Ha, native forest area : 1004 Ha)



Map of 57 properties in Parintins (total area : 1813 Ha, native forest area : 1279 Ha)



Map of 27 properties in Urucara (total area : 868 Ha, native forest area : 645 Ha)

1.14 Conditions Prior to Project Initiation

Ecosystem Type:

The GUARANATUBA REDD+ AUDD Grouped Project is located in the Amazon Forest, a region characterized by its high biodiversity and substantial biomass storage. The predominant ecosystem in the project area is a Terrestrial Forest Ecosystem, more specifically a Tropical Rainforest dominated by Dense Ombrophilous Forest with Lowland subtypes (Db). The primary soil types found in the project area are Latosols and Argisols. Historically, the region has suffered from a lack of state action regarding sustainable production and support for local communities, which has contributed to the degradation of this valuable ecosystem.

Current and Historical Land Use:

The project region has been subject to various pressures over time, largely related to the growth and urbanization of the nearby cities of Parintins, Maues and Urucará, as well as the development of agricultural and cattle ranching activities. The construction of improved access to rural properties has further facilitated these pressures. In recent years, the region has experienced increasing pressure from other forms of exploitation, both legal and illegal, including logging, livestock, mining, natural gas exploitation, and agriculture. These activities have stimulated migration and occupation of the area, directly impacting the flow of people in the region and placing additional stress on the ecosystem.

Present and Prior Environmental Conditions:

The GUARANATUBA project area, situated in the heart of the Amazon, experiences a humid tropical climate and features a diverse hydrological network, varied topography, and rich soils, including Latosols and Argisols. The region is renowned for its dense tropical rainforest ecosystem, which hosts significant biodiversity and stores substantial amounts of biomass. However, prior to the project's initiation, the area was subject to minimal sustainable management and community support, resulting in a negative impact on the natural environment. This lack of effective management and conservation efforts highlight the critical importance of the GUARANATUBA project in preserving and restoring these vital ecological systems.

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1.15 Compliance with Laws, Statutes and Other Regulatory Frameworks

The project proponent, Organica Consultoria, is dedicated to adhering to all pertinent Brazilian laws and regulations. In pursuit of compliance, Organica Consultoria collaborates with legal advisors who are experts in local and relevant regulatory frameworks.

National and Local Laws

Currently no laws and regulations prevent or enforce the Project activity or baseline land use scenarios. No law in Brazil prohibits or restricts the execution of REDD+ Projects or prohibits or restricts any commercial transaction of assets generated from the same Projects. Project-relevant laws, statutes and policies are outlined below.

Regulatory framework

Brazil is a member of the United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change (UNFCCC) and an active member of the International Tropical Timber Organisation (ITTO). The country has ratified the UNFCCC (1995), the Kyoto Protocol (2005), and has established a Designated National Authority under the Clean Development Mechanism (CDM) and has implemented registered CDM Afforestation/Reforestation Projects. Brazil is also a signatory to the Paris Agreement (Paris 2015, COP 2167). The Project complies with this regulatory framework due to its AFOLU scope, which is a recognized method of GHG reductions and removals under the regulatory framework.

National legislation

The Guaranatuba Project observes the principles established in the Brazilian Federal Constitution, as per Article 225, by contribution towards the achievement of an ecologically balanced environment. An overview of the main national laws regulating the forest sector is provided below. These laws regulate the use and protection of native natural forests and also regulate the management and exploitation of commercial forests derived from reforestation projects.

- **Law n° 12.727 - October 17, 2012**. – this law establishes general norms on the protection of vegetation, areas of Permanent Preservation and the areas of Legal Reserve; Logging, supply of forest raw materials, control of the origin of forest products and control and prevention of forest fires and provides economic and financial instruments to achieve its objectives.
- **Law n° 12.651 - May 25, 2012.** - establishes the New Brazilian Forest Code, including provisions for managing forests and the Legal Reserve.

- **Law n° 7.804 - July 18, 1989**. - amends Law 6.938, dated August 31, 1981, which provides for the National Policy on the Environment, its purposes and mechanisms for formulation and application, Law 7,735 of February 22, 1989, Law 6803, of July 2, 1980, and makes other provisions.

The Project complies with the law requirements of land use and sustainable forest management. According to Law n° 12.651/2012, all rural property in forested areas must maintain 80% of the property area with native vegetation coverage, as a Legal Reserve. This is an area located inside a rural property, with the function of ensuring the sustainable use of the natural resources of the rural property, assisting the conservation and rehabilitation of ecological processes and promoting the conservation of biodiversity, as well as the shelter and protection of wildlife and native flora.

The Project complies with this law by preventing illegal deforestation of the Legal Reserve in rural properties within the Project Area. Forest surveillance implemented as part of AUD Project activities also enables better monitoring of the forest conditions and improves compliance with the currently enforced laws and regulations.

Law n° 12.651/2012 also allows for sustainable management of forests and provides the following opportunities:

- The collection of non-timber forest products, such as fruits, flowers, vines, leaves, roots and seeds, which do not endanger the survival of individuals and of the species collected, is allowed (Article 21).
- Sustainable forestry is forbidden for commercial purposes but it's allowed for use in the property, with a maximum limit of 20 cubic metres/year (Article 23).
- It is not allowed cattle farming or any other agricultural activity.

The Project complies with opportunities for activities within sustainable forest management.

<u>National policy</u>

The Project activity is carried out in compliance with the environmental policies and guidelines from the Brazilian Federal Administration under the standards set at the COP 14 Conference held in Poznan, Poland, in December 2008. These guidelines set a goal of reducing deforestation by 70 percent by the year 2018 and moving to a zero-deforestation goal by 2030. These goals aim to offset the GHG emissions resulting from illegal deforestation. GHG offsets from illegal deforestation is part of the Brazilian Nationally Determined Contribution which Brazil plans to adopt under the framework of the Paris Climate Agreement (COP-21).

The Action Plan for the Prevention and Control of Deforestation in the Legal Amazon (PPCDAm; Plano de Ação para a Prevenção e Controle do Desmatamento na Amazônia Legal) was established to mitigate the escalation in deforestation in the Legal Amazon. This Project activity follows the main PPCDAm premises. The Project will comply with this plan by implementing actions to prevent deforestation, as is the intent of the plan.

<u>Amazon State Laws</u>

- State Law No. 3,785, July 24, 2012, provides for environmental licensing in the state of Amazonas.
- Law No. 3,789, July 27, 2012, provides for forest replacement in the state of Amazonas.
- State Decree No. 32,986, November 30, 2012. Regulates Law No. 3,789/2012, which provides for forest replacement in the state of Amazonas.

At a state level, Amazonas state has public policy measures in place facilitating forest conservation. However, these policies do not offer a definitive regulation or limit to the execution of REDD+ Projects by either public or private enterprises within the state territory.

1.16 Double Counting and Participation under Other GHG Programs

1.16.1 No Double Issuance

Is the project receiving or seeking credit for reductions and removals from a project activity under another GHG program?

☐ Yes ☒ No

1.16.2 Registration in Other GHG Programs

Is the project registered or seeking registration under any other GHG programs?

☐ Yes ☒ No

1.16.3 Projects Rejected by Other GHG Programs

Has the project been rejected by any other GHG programs?

☐ Yes ☒ No

1.17 Double Claiming, Other Forms of Credit, and Scope 3 Emissions

1.17.1 No Double Claiming with Emissions Trading Programs or Binding Emission Limits

Are project reductions and removals or project activities also included in an emissions trading program or binding emission limit? See the *VCS Program Definitions* for definitions of emissions trading program and binding emission limit.

☐ Yes ☒ No

1.17.2 No Double Claiming with Other Forms of Environmental Credit

Has the project activity sought, received, or is planning to receive credit from another GHG-related environmental credit system? See the *VCS Program Definitions* for definition of GHG-related environmental credit system.

☐ Yes ☒ No

1.17.3 Supply Chain (Scope 3) Emissions

Do the project activities specified in Section 1.12 affect the emissions footprint of any product(s) (goods or services) that are part of a supply chain?

☐ Yes ☒ No

1.18 Sustainable Development Contributions

The GUARANATUBA Project, spearheaded by Organica Consultoria in Urucara, Maues and Parintins, Amazonas, is an all-encompassing sustainable development initiative that incorporates a diverse array of activities aimed at fostering environmental sustainability, economic resilience, and social well-being within the project area.

Central to the project's approach is the utilization of cutting-edge agroforestry techniques, extensive reforestation efforts to restore degraded land, and the implementation of sustainable agricultural practices. By employing these methods, the project strives to enhance productivity and biodiversity while simultaneously sequestering carbon and combating climate change. Complementing these efforts are community-based conservation programs designed to safeguard endemic wildlife, improve ecological health, and ensure sustainable land use practices are adopted.

The far-reaching objectives of the GUARANATUBA Project extend beyond environmental concerns, as it also seeks to deliver socio-economic benefits to local communities. By enhancing food security and creating livelihood opportunities, the project aims to uplift the living standards of those residing in the area. Sustainable agricultural practices are expected to yield multiple benefits, including improved soil health, increased agricultural productivity, and the provision of stable income sources for local communities. Moreover, the conservation efforts undertaken by the project will protect vital ecosystems and wildlife, ensuring their preservation for future generations.

Aligning seamlessly with Brazil's sustainable development priorities, the GUARANATUBA Project contributes significantly to forest conservation, biodiversity promotion, and community livelihood support. It directly addresses pressing issues such as climate action, life on land, and the reduction of inequalities. To ensure transparent progress tracking and alignment with national strategies, robust monitoring and reporting mechanisms have been put in place. These measures allow for necessary adjustments to be made, maximizing the project's potential to achieve sustainable development outcomes.

The project's contributions to the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) are manifold and far-reaching. By employing people to carry out project activities, the GUARANATUBA Project aims to decrease the proportion of the population living below the international poverty line, thereby addressing SDG 1.1. The project places a strong emphasis on community engagement, as evidenced by its commitment to increasing participation in nutritional and health lectures, which aligns with SDG 3.d. Recognizing the importance of gender equality, the project actively promotes gender parity in education, contributing to the achievement of SDG 4.5.

In terms of economic empowerment, the GUARANATUBA Project seeks to increase informal employment opportunities, thus addressing SDG 8.3. This is achieved through the creation of jobs related to project activities, providing a means for local communities to generate income and improve their livelihoods.

Climate change mitigation and adaptation are at the forefront of the project's priorities. By improving education, awareness-raising, and capacity-building efforts related to climate change, the project contributes to SDG 13.3. Furthermore, through its reforestation and sustainable land use practices, the project aims to reduce greenhouse gas emissions, aligning with SDG 13.0.

The GUARANATUBA Project's commitment to environmental sustainability is further demonstrated by its efforts to increase forest areas as a proportion of total land area, which directly addresses SDG 15.1. By promoting sustainable forest management practices, the project also contributes to SDG 15.2, ensuring that the region's forests are preserved and managed responsibly.

To ensure the project's success and long-term viability, specific goals for each proposed activity are currently being developed using the theory of change framework. These goals will be presented in the project's future documentation, providing a clear roadmap for the implementation and evaluation of the project's various initiatives.

In conclusion, the GUARANATUBA Project is a multifaceted sustainable development initiative that combines environmental conservation, economic empowerment, and social well-being. Through its innovative approaches and commitment to achieving the Sustainable Development Goals, the project holds immense potential to transform the lives of local communities while protecting the region's invaluable natural resources.

1.19 Additional Information Relevant to the Project

1.19.1 Leakage Management

This section is still under development and will be presented in the next version of the Project Description

1.19.2 Commercially Sensitive Information

Information considered commercially sensitive includes any data—be it trade, financial, technical, or otherwise—that, if disclosed, could materially impact financial standings or affect contractual negotiations as outlined by the project proponent. Additionally, sensitive information encompasses internal policy decisions and other details where public disclosure could negatively impact a project's development or execution. Conversely, details on project social activities, baseline scenario determinations, additionality demonstrations, and GHG emission reduction estimations, including operational and capital expenditures, are deemed non-sensitive and are disclosed in public project documents.

1.19.3 Further Information

This section is still under development and will be presented in the next version of the Project Description

2 SAFEGUARDS AND STAKEHOLDER ENGAGEMENT

2.1 Stakeholder Engagement and Consultation

2.1.1 Stakeholder Identification

This section is still under development and will be presented in the next version of the Project Description..

2.1.2 Stakeholder Consultation and Ongoing Communication

This section is still under development and will be presented in the next version of the Project Description.

2.1.3 Free Prior and Informed Consent

This section is still under development and will be presented in the next version of the Project Description..

2.1.4 Grievance Redress Procedure

This section is still under development and will be presented in the next version of the Project Description..

2.1.5 Public Comments

This section is still under development and will be presented in the next version of the Project Description..

2.2 Risks to Stakeholders and the Environment

This section is still under development and will be presented in the next version of the Project Description..

2.3 Respect for Human Rights and Equity

This section is still under development and will be presented in the next version of the Project Description..

2.4 Ecosystem Health

This section is still under development and will be presented in the next version of the Project Description..

3 APPLICATION OF METHODOLOGY

3.1 Title and Reference of Methodology

This grouped project uses the approved VCS methodology VM0015 Methodology for Avoiding Unplanned Deforestation (AUD) v1.2, published on 18-December-2023.

Also, the following tools were used:

- VT0001 – Tool for demonstration and assessment of Additionality in VCS Agriculture, Forestry and Other Land Use (AFOLU) Project Activities, v3.0, published on 01-February-2012.
- AFOLU Non-Permanence Risk Tool v4.2, published on 12-octobre-2023.

Type (methodology, tool or module).	Reference ID, if applicable	Title	Version
Methodology	*VM0015*		*1.2*

		VM0015 REDD+ Methodology Framework (REDD+MF),	
Tool	*VT0001*	*Tool for demonstration and assessment of Additionality in VCS Agriculture, Forestry and Other Land Use (AFOLU) Project Activities*	*3.0*
Tool	*NPRT*	*AFOLU Non-Permanence Risk Tool*	*4.2*

3.2 Applicability of Methodology

VM0015 – Methodology for Avoided Unplanned Deforestation, v1.2	
Applicability Conditions	Justification of Applicability
a) Baseline activities may include planned or unplanned logging for timber, fuelwood collection, charcoal production, agricultural and grazing activities as long as the category is unplanned deforestation according to the most recent VCS AFOLU requirements.	None of the baseline land-use conversion activities are legally designated or sanctioned for forestry or deforestation, and hence the project activity qualifies as avoided unplanned deforestation. This is in accordance with the definition of unplanned deforestation under the VCS Standard v4. The primary land uses in the baseline scenario are: cattle ranching, mainly for producing beef cattle; and timber harvest, acting both legally and illegally. These unplanned deforestation and degradation agents have been attracted due to infrastructure , such as waterways and roads. Therefore, in the baseline scenario, the Project Area would continue to be illegally

	deforested by the deforestation agents described above. With that said, the present criteria are fulfilled.
b) Project activities may include one or a combination of the eligible categories defined in the description of the scope of the methodology (table 1 and figure 2).	Within the categories of Table 1 and Figure 2 of the Methodology, the present Project Activity falls within category A, “Avoided Deforestation without Logging”. The reason is that the project area contains 100% native vegetation and has never been deforested in the past. In addition, it is important to note that degradation is not included neither in the baseline nor in the project scenario.
c) The project area can include different types of forest, such as, but not limited to, old growth forest, degraded forest, secondary forests, planted forests and agroforestry systems meeting the definition of “forest”.	These forest classes composing the Project Area are named as per the Technical Manual for Brazilian Vegetation[2]. The area is considered forest as per the definition of adopted by FAO[3]: Land spanning more than 0.5 hectares with trees higher than 5 meters and a canopy cover of more than 10%, or trees able to reach these thresholds in situ. No deforested, degraded or areas otherwise modified by humans were included in the Project Area at the Project Start Date.
d) At project commencement, the project area shall include only land qualifying as “forest” for a minimum of 10 years prior to the project start date.	The Project Area consisted of 100% tropical rainforest in 2007 – over 10 years prior to the project start date – all of which according

[2] Avaliable at https://www.terrabrasilis.org.br/ecotecadigital/pdf/manual-tecnico-da-vegetacao-brasileira.pdf
[3] Available at < https://www.fao.org/3/y4171e/y4171e10.htm#:~:text=FAO%202000a%20(FRA%202000%20Main,of%20other%20predominant% 20land%20uses>

	to the Brazilian definition of forest[4]. This was ascertained using satellite images, as described in the section Baseline Scenario of the present VCS PD.
e) The project area can include forested wetlands (such as bottomland forests, floodplain forests, mangrove forests) as long as they do not grow on peat. Peat shall be defined as organic soils with at least 65% organic matter and a minimum thickness of 50 cm. If the project area includes forested wetlands growing on peat (e.g. peat swamp forests), this methodology is not applicable.	As described at Section 1.13 of the present VCS PD, the only soil type within the Project Area is the dystrophic Red-Yellow Argosols. Therefore, no peat or peat swamp forests were found within the Project Area, satisfying this applicability criterion.

VT0001 – Tool for demonstration and assessment of Additionality in VCS Agriculture, Forestry and Other Land Use (AFOLU) Project Activities, v3.0	
Applicability Conditions	Justification of Applicability

[4] Brazil adopts the FAO forest definition: “Land with tree crown cover (or equivalent stocking level) of more than 10 percent and area of more than 0.5 hectares (ha). The trees should be able to reach a minimum height of 5 meters (m) at maturity in situ.” Available at: <http://www.fao.org/docrep/006/ad665e/ad665e06.htm>.

a) AFOLU activities the same or similar to the proposed project activity on the land within the proposed project boundary performed with or without being registered as the VCS AFOLU project shall not lead to violation of any applicable law even if the law is not enforced;	The present AFOLU project activity does not involve any economic activity apart from forest conservation, i.e., there are no financial or economic benefits other than VCUs related income. Therefore, it does not lead to violation of any applicable law even if the law is not enforced. Sustainable Forest Management Plan is an authorized and endorsed activity in Brazil, and Instances must have all environmental and legal authorizations necessary to conduct the activity, should it be the case for new Instances joining the Project, as Instance 1 does not perform sustainable forest management activities.
b) The use of this tool to determine additionality requires the baseline methodology to provide for a stepwise approach justifying the determination of the most plausible baseline scenario. Project proponent(s) proposing new baseline methodologies shall ensure consistency between the determination of a baseline scenario and the determination of additionality of a project activity.	The Methodology provides a stepwise approach to justify the determination of the most plausible baseline scenario, which is detailed at Section 3.4 – Baseline Scenario, below.

NPRT – AFOLU Non-Permanence Risk Tool, v4.2	
Applicability Conditions	Justification of Applicability

a) AFOLU activities the same or similar to the proposed project activity on the land within the proposed project boundary performed with or without being registered as the VCS AFOLU project shall not lead to violation of any applicable law even if the law is not enforced;	The present AFOLU project activity does not involve any economic activity apart from forest conservation, i.e., there are no financial or economic benefits other than VCUs related income. Therefore, it does not lead to violation of any applicable law even if the law is not enforced. Sustainable Forest Management Plan is an authorized and endorsed activity in Brazil, and Instances must have all environmental and legal authorizations necessary to conduct the activity, should it be the case for new Instances joining the Project, as Instance 1 does not perform sustainable forest management activities.

3.3 Project Boundary

This section is still under development and will be presented in the next version of the Project Description.

3.4 Baseline Scenario

This section is still under development and will be presented in the next version of the Project Description.

3.5 Additionality

This section is still under development and will be presented in the next version of the Project Description.

3.5.1 Additionality Methods

This section is still under development and will be presented in the next version of the Project Description.

3.6 Methodology Deviations

This section is still under development and will be presented in the next version of the Project Description.

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4 QUANTIFICATION OF ESTIMATED GHG EMISSION REDUCTIONS AND REMOVALS

4.1 Baseline Emissions

This section is still under development and will be presented in the next version of the Project Description

4.2 Project Emissions

This section is still under development and will be presented in the next version of the Project Description

4.3 Leakage Emissions

This section is still under development and will be presented in the next version of the Project Description

4.4 Estimated GHG Emission Reductions and Carbon Dioxide Removals

This section is still under development and will be presented in the next version of the Project Description.

5 MONITORING

5.1 Data and Parameters Available at Validation

This section is still under development and will be presented in the next version of the Project Description.

5.2 Data and Parameters Monitored

This section is still under development and will be presented in the next version of the Project Description.

5.3 Monitoring Plan

This section is still under development and will be presented in the next version of the Project Description.